

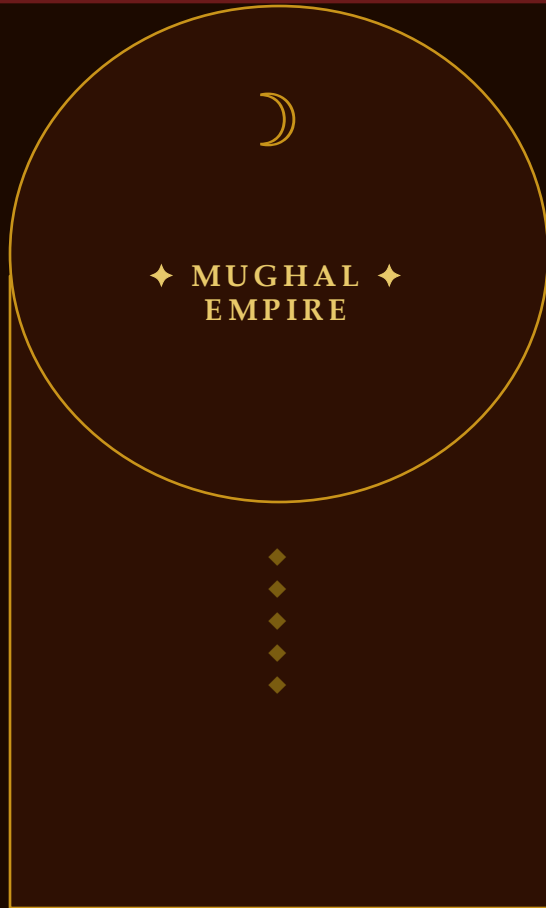


❖ THE COMPLETE HISTORY ❖

THE MUGHAL EMPIRE

Babur to Bahadur Shah Zafar • 1526 – 1857

Ali Abbas • Sahil Bhagesh • Anish Kumar • Nawab Jahangir • Muhammad Raza



Origins of the Mughal Empire

- The word 'Mughal' derives from the Persian word for 'Mongol'
- Founded by Zahiruddin Muhammad Babur in 1526 AD
- Babur was a descendant of Timur (Tamerlane) on his father's side and Genghis Khan on his mother's
- Babur ruled Fergana, then Samarkand, then Kabul before conquering India
- The empire emerged after Babur defeated the fragmented Lodi Sultanate of Delhi
- Mughal rule would last over 300 years, shaping the entire Indian subcontinent

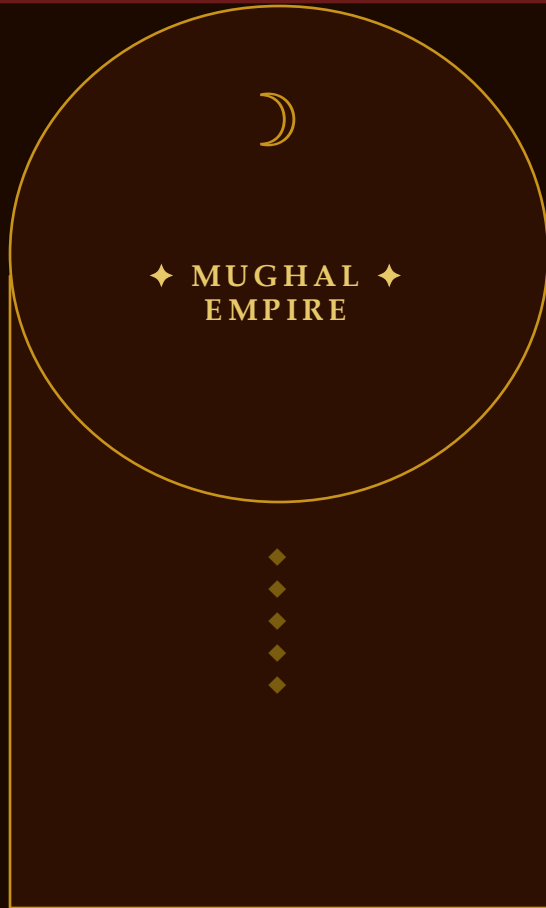


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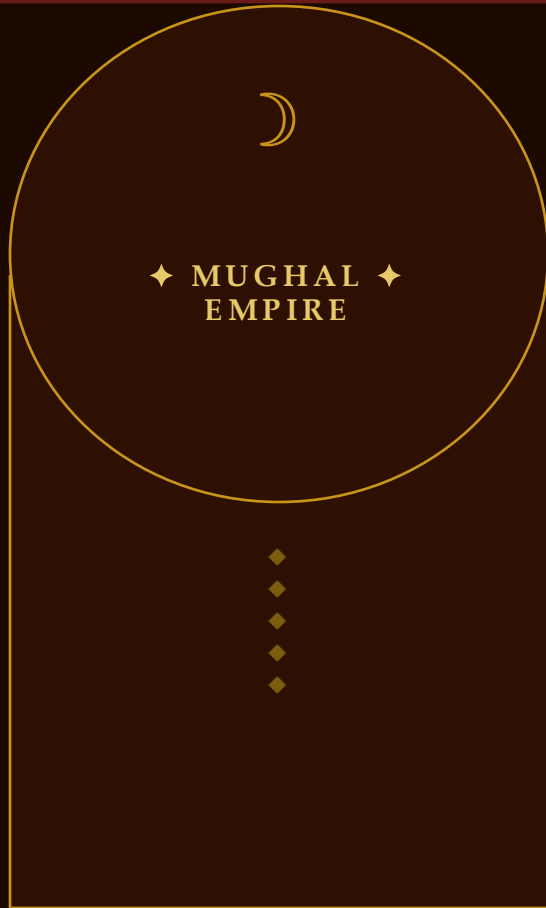
The First Battle of Panipat (1526)

- Fought on April 21, 1526 between Babur and Ibrahim Lodi, Sultan of Delhi
- Babur's army of ~12,000 faced Ibrahim Lodi's force of over 100,000 soldiers
- Babur used field artillery and flanking tactics — a revolutionary approach in India
- The Lodi army, unaccustomed to cannon fire, was routed — Ibrahim Lodi was killed
- This battle marked the end of the Delhi Sultanate and the start of Mughal rule
- Babur captured Delhi and Agra, establishing the foundation of the Mughal Empire



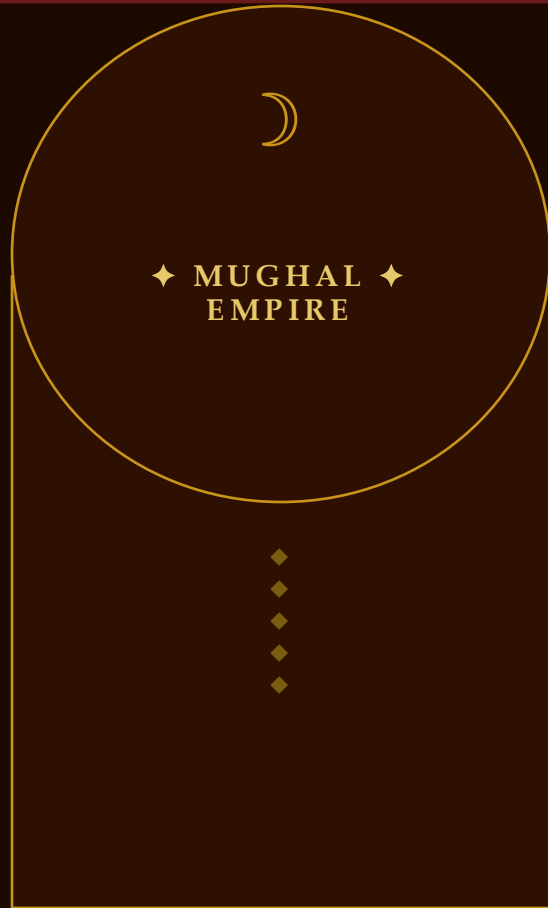
Babur — The Founder (1526–1530)

- Babur ruled India for only four years but laid the foundations of a great empire
- He introduced Persian culture, literature, and garden architecture to the subcontinent
- His autobiography, the Baburnama, is one of the greatest works of Mughal literature
- He introduced the 'char-bagh' (four-garden) style seen in later Mughal monuments
- Babur died in 1530 at Agra; legend says he gave his life for his sick son Humayun
- Buried in Kabul, Afghanistan — his tomb (Bagh-e-Babur) still stands today



Humayun — The Struggling Emperor

- Naseeruddin Humayun ruled 1530–1540 then 1555–1556 after recapturing India
- He faced rebellions from his own brothers and from Sher Shah Suri
- Sher Shah Suri defeated Humayun at the Battles of Chausa (1539) and Kanauj (1540)
- Humayun spent 15 years in exile, living in Persia under Shah Tahmasp's protection
- With Persian support, Humayun reconquered India in 1555, defeating Sikandar Sur
- He died in 1556 from a fatal fall down the stairs of his library in Delhi



Akbar the Great — The Golden Age

- Jalaluddin Muhammad Akbar ruled from 1556 to 1605 — the longest Mughal reign
- Expanded the empire across most of the Indian subcontinent through conquest and diplomacy
- Famous for religious tolerance — married Hindu Rajput princess Jodha Bai
- Created 'Din-i-Ilahi', a syncretic movement blending Islam, Hinduism, and other faiths
- Abolished the Jizya tax on non-Muslims and welcomed scholars of all faiths at court
- His court included the 'Navaratnas' (Nine Gems) — nine extraordinary scholars and ministers



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Akbar's Administration & Culture

- Introduced the Mansabdari system — a military and civil rank system for administrators
- Land revenue reform (Todar Mal's Bandobast) brought economic stability to the empire
- Built Fatehpur Sikri — a grand new capital blending Islamic and Hindu architecture
- The city was abandoned within 14 years, possibly due to water scarcity
- Under Akbar, Mughal painting flourished — a fusion of Persian and Indian styles
- Despite being illiterate, Akbar was a great patron of art, music, and literature



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Jahangir — The Emperor of Art

- Nuruddin Muhammad Jahangir (son of Akbar) ruled from 1605 to 1627
- His name means 'Conqueror of the World' — a title adopted upon the throne
- Famous for his deep passion for painting and nature — kept detailed diaries of flora & fauna
- His court painter Ustad Mansur became legendary for realistic animal paintings
- Jahangir married Nur Jahan — the most powerful woman in Mughal history; she co-ruled effectively
- His reign saw growing trade with the British East India Company and European powers



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Shah Jahan — Builder of Wonders

- Shahab-ud-din Muhammad Shah Jahan ruled from 1628 to 1658
- Known as the 'Prince of Builders' — the empire reached its architectural peak
- Built the Taj Mahal (1632–1653) in memory of his beloved wife Mumtaz Mahal
- Also built the Red Fort (Lal Qila) and Jama Masjid in Delhi — both UNESCO heritage sites
- Constructed the legendary Peacock Throne — the most expensive throne ever built
- Imprisoned by his own son Aurangzeb in 1658, spending final years gazing at the Taj Mahal



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Aurangzeb — The Last Great Mughal

- Muhi-ud-Din Muhammad Aurangzeb Alamgir ruled from 1658 to 1707 — for 49 years
- Expanded the empire to its greatest territorial extent — covering most of South Asia
- Reversed Akbar's tolerant policies — reimposed Jizya tax on non-Muslims
- Destroyed several Hindu temples and banned music and art at the royal court
- His policies alienated Rajputs, Marathas, Sikhs, and Deccan kingdoms
- After his death, the empire rapidly fragmented — he is seen as both conqueror and divider



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Mughal Art, Architecture & Culture

- Mughal architecture blends Persian, Islamic, Timurid, and Indian Hindu styles
- Key features: bulbous domes, minarets, intricate inlay work (pietra dura), charbagh gardens
- Monuments: Taj Mahal, Red Fort, Humayun's Tomb, Agra Fort, Fatehpur Sikri
- Mughal miniature painting — detailed, vibrant court scenes, battles, and nature illustrations
- Music flourished — Tansen, the greatest classical musician, served in Akbar's court
- Mughal cuisine introduced kebabs, biryanis, and rich curries still beloved today

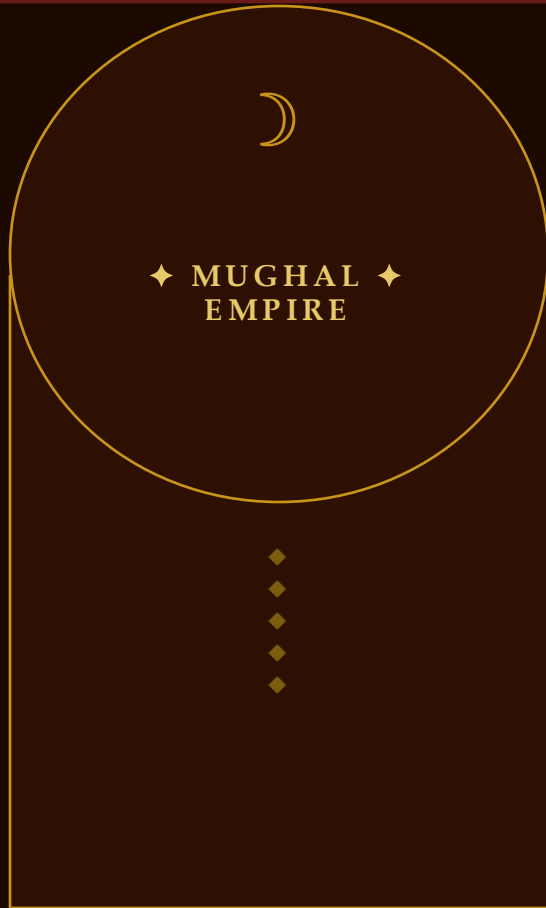


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Mughal Economy & Trade

- The Mughal Empire was one of the largest economies in the world — ~25% of global GDP at peak
- Agriculture was the backbone: cotton, indigo, silk, and spices were major exports
- Thriving trade with Persia, Central Asia, Arabia, and later European powers
- European powers (British, Dutch, Portuguese) established trading posts during this era
- The British East India Company received its first firman (trade permit) from Jahangir in 1612
- Surat was the main port — a bustling hub of international maritime commerce



The Decline of the Mughal Empire

- After Aurangzeb's death (1707), 12 emperors ruled in 150 years — most were weak and nominal
- The Marathas under Shivaji and later the Peshwas became a major rival power
- Nadir Shah of Persia invaded Delhi in 1739, massacring thousands and looting the Peacock Throne
- Ahmad Shah Durrani defeated Mughals and Marathas at the Third Battle of Panipat (1761)
- British East India Company gradually took over provinces, exploiting Mughal weakness
- By 1803, the Mughal emperor was effectively a British pensioner in the Red Fort



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The War of Independence 1857

- Called the Sepoy Mutiny by the British, War of Independence by Indians
- Sepoys (Indian soldiers) revolted over the greased cartridges controversy
- The last Mughal emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar II was declared leader of the rebellion
- Major uprisings erupted in Delhi, Lucknow, Kanpur, Jhansi, and across North India
- The British brutally suppressed the rebellion after months of fierce fighting
- Bahadur Shah Zafar was arrested, tried, and exiled to Rangoon (Yangon), Burma



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Bahadur Shah Zafar — The Last Mughal

- Bahadur Shah Zafar II (1775–1862) — the last emperor of the Mughal dynasty
- He was primarily a poet and mystic, not a warrior — his rule was mostly nominal
- His Urdu poetry is among the finest in the language — expressing longing and exile
- Famous verse: 'Lagta nahin hai dil mera ujre dayar mein' — a lament about homelessness
- After the 1857 failure, the British exiled him to Burma where he died in 1862
- He reportedly said: 'Two yards of my native soil were not available for my burial'



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Legacy of the Mughal Empire

- The Mughal Empire lasted 331 years (1526–1857), shaping South Asian civilization profoundly
- Urdu language — a blend of Persian, Arabic, and Hindi — was born in Mughal courts
- Mughal architecture remains iconic: the Taj Mahal is visited by millions every year
- The modern nations of India, Pakistan, and Bangladesh are heirs to this cultural legacy
- Mughal administrative systems influenced later British colonial governance in India
- The story of the Mughals — glory, culture, and eventual collapse — remains one of history's epics



❖ JAZAK ALLAH KHAIR ❖

THANK YOU

"Not just an empire — a civilization."

Ali Abbas • Sahil Bhagesh • Anish Kumar • Nawab Jahangir • Muhammad Raza